



**MFC
YOUTH**

HOUSEHOLD SERVANTS JUMPSTART *manual*



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Rationale

In our MFC Youth community, we put much value in the spiritual nourishment of all our household servants for it is through this that we know that our brothers and sisters can be sustained in their personal relationship with the Lord. Thus, household topics for household servants should be highly regarded too. It should always be excellent by making sure that it is well prepared and highly nourishing. Every household meeting of the household servants must be an opportunity for them to personally experience the Lord and grow in their conviction to live out the call that they received from the Lord.

This Household Servant's Jumpstart Manual will help guide and equip the chapter servants in making their household meetings with their household servants excellent and nourishing.

General Objective

The goals of this manual are:

1. to guide the chapter servants in leading their household meetings
2. to serve as a template for the chapter servants to topics that will help household servants to embrace their calling as pastors to the young.

Manual Description

The MFC Youth Household Servant's Jumpstart Manual is composed of 10 household topics that will help our household servants to grow in their conviction to be good pastors for the young.

List down below are the different topics under this manual:

1. Being a Servant
2. Building Relationship
3. Zeal for Righteousness
4. Imitators of Christ
5. Focusing on the Lord
6. Giving Encouragement
7. Giving Correction
8. The Power to Intercede
9. The Power of Prayer
10. Faith the Moves Mountains

How to Use this Manual

There are 10 household topics in this manual. These topics are independent from each other, thus, you can choose any topic that you feel that your household need to discussed for the week.

1. The **GOAL** part is just to guide the household leader to what lesson that particular topic is aiming for.
2. The **GRAB** part is a warm-up just to loosen up the discussion in the household. It is a question that requires no right or wrong answers and just asks for the opinion of each member.
3. The **GRACE** part is the 'meat' of the household topic. The Bible verse/s is/are read first. You can ask one of your members to read the verses. For the text, assign persons to read each paragraph aloud.
4. The **GATHER** part is the sharing part of the household. It allows each member to look to himself/herself and ask how the lessons in the household apply to him/her. Every member is asked to share his/her reflections.
5. The **GO FORTH** part is a challenge to take the lessons of the household into concrete steps. The household head should check whether the actions are being done by his/her members during their one-to-ones or before the next household starts.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Being a Servant

Goal:

- To learn what it really means to be a servant in MFC Youth.
- To actively respond in God's call for them to serve their brethren in MFC Youth.

Grab:

List down your Top 3 role-model when it comes to serving God in the community?
Please share they inspires you?

Grace:

In order to be better MFC Youth Household Servants, we need to understand the nature of Christian service. Christian service is not simply what you do, but who you are as you do it. There are three important New Testament passages that we will study in order to clarify our understanding of what it means to be a servant.

A. The Duty of a Servant (Luke 17:7-10)

We have lost touch with the real meaning of the word "servant" as understood in Jesus' time. During those times, a servant (or slave) was someone who was another person's property and had no rights whatsoever. Thus Jesus' story must have been amusing to his listeners. They could not comprehend a situation where the servant is served by his master. We are the Lord's servants. We have been bought at the price of his blood. We no longer own ourselves. We are to be men and women who serve the Lord without regard for ourselves.

B. The Identity of a Servant (Philippians 2:5-8)

Christian service is not just another avenue for self-fulfillment. We have no basis for insisting that God give us work to do that suits our personality, interests or personal gains. The Christian doesn't seek to serve himself. Rather, he humbles himself and puts himself at the disposal of everyone else.

C. The Obedience of a Servant (Hebrews 5:8)

A requirement of the Lordship of Jesus and our own servanthood is obedience to his authority. Obedience cannot be halfway or half-hearted. Either Jesus is Lord of all areas of our life, or our claim that Jesus is our Master and Lord becomes meaningless.

The Lord does not just want us to be enthusiastic and willing servants, but He wants us to be mature Christian servants. He wants people He can truly count on and it is our privilege to be considered as one.

Gather:

How can I improve in living out my calling as a Household Servant?

Go Forth:

This week commit to serve your household members by doing a simple act of kindness to them



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Building Relationship

Goals:

- To learn the importance of building relationships with your members.
- To commit to grow in relationships with every member of your household.

Grab:

Think of three (3) things about yourself where two (2) are true and one (1) is false. As you say these three things about yourself as your household to determine what is true and what is false. This will reveal how much we know each other.

Grace:

Read: 1 Thessalonians 2:7-12

Our role as household servant is to reach out to our members and help move them on in their relationship with the Lord and grow in our relationship as brothers and sisters. However, this is impossible to achieve if we will not choose to build our relationship with our members. In order for us to excel in the personal care of our members we choose to:

1. Be Gentle with Them (v.7)

Do not come down too hard on your member's shortcomings. Try to be more understanding towards them. This doesn't mean that you won't have to correct them for their shortcomings rather when it is necessary you also need to be firm towards them.

2. Give Them Personal Care (v.8)

Our relationship in our household is pastoral and not just a functional. Thus we take an interest in their interests. We tried to get to know each of them personally (ex. Family, Friends, School, Hobby). We also tried to get to know their concerns and problems and strive to help them out. We also tried to visit them in their homes and in their school. We make clear that our relationship as brothers and sisters is important for us and we are committed to serve them.

3. Persevere in Pastoring Them (v.9)

It is a battle to change people and bring them closer to God. It will not just happen easily, that is why we need to persevere in reaching out to our members. We strive to always be open and available to them.

4. Show our Integrity (v.10)

The only way for us to be an effective HH servants is to be an effective witness to your household. Thus, we strive to be a person who is beyond reproach. It is not just a question of not sinning, but of not doing anything that can destroy your integrity as a Christian.



5. Encourage Them (v.11)

When they opens up to you, be able to hold them up with your support. Just like a father to his children who provide encouragement, comfort, and support. We too tried to do that to our members.

Gather:

Considering the points above, Can you share about how can you improve in building relationship with your members?

Go Forth:

This week commit to practice one of the points discussed in 1 Thessalonians 2:7-12.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Zeal for Righteousness

Goal:

- To learn how to love God and neighbor.
- To express one's love for God and neighbor.

Grab:

Share about a particular experience where you felt that you are truly love.

Grace:

Read: Mark 12: 30-31

Zeal for righteousness stems from the very basis of our Christianity, namely, love of God and of neighbor.

A person who loves God not only desires to enjoy His goodness and be close to Him, but loves to see His will accomplished. That person tries to worship God by honoring Him with his lifestyle. He wants all people to know, love, serve and honor God more than anything else.

While a person who loves his neighbor desires not only good things for him, but even more, the salvation of other people. Thus, our love of God and neighbor should cause us to mourn if God is dishonored or disobeyed and if others are not in right relationship with Him.

Although all Christians should love God and their neighbor, living out this call is especially necessary for us household servants. Our position as pastoral head of our members demands that our hearts should be as much moved by love of righteousness and hatred of evil, as is God's heart. Thus we give importance in our effort to grow in loving God and our neighbor and we strive to do this by:

1. **Being Holy** – we strive to be faithful to our covenant in MFC Youth.
2. **Actively Participation in the life of the Church** – we strive to receive all the graces that God gives us by frequently receiving the sacraments and actively joining the life of our parish.
3. **Being Selfless** – we strive to deny our self, take up our crosses and follow the Lord.

Gather:

Look inside ourselves and try to see if we possess a heart that mourn if God is dishonored and if others are not in right relationship with Him? What can I do to grow more in love for God and neighbor?

Go Forth:

This week commit to spend more time in prayer and to share about your relationship with God to your friends outside community.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Imitators of Christ

Goals:

- To learn how to be a good role model to your household.
- To commit to imitate Christ in their daily lives.

Grab:

If there is a person who you want to imitate who will it be and why?

Grace:

Read: 1 Corinthians 11: 1

Integrity is the refusal to justify, rationalize or excuse any motivation, thought or behavior that is inconsistent with the commands and principles of God's Word. We are not talking of not having any sin (we all still fall into sin), but refusal to justify it. You see a person can have skill, education, even God's anointing, but can still have no integrity. That is why as MFC Youth household servant we make sure that we protect our integrity because when we lost it, we also lost our moral authority to lead God's people. Hence, it is important that we make sure that we try to imitate Christ and show it through our:

1. Morals

A good servant is someone who strives to live out the teaching of Jesus Christ. It is being expressed in the way we speak, think and do. It is not about just keeping a minimum standard of doing good but a pursuit to be holy.

2. Family Life

A good servant is someone who proves himself in the care and value they give to their family. Thus, we give the same quality of time and love to your parents and siblings in the same way we give time and love for our service in the community. At times we care for our household members but neglect our family. Never forget that MFC Youth is a family oriented ministry.

3. Ministry

A good servant is someone who lived out our covenant with God and our culture in MFC Youth. It is expressed by being faithful in attending our meetings, being punctual, being loving in speech and action. It is practiced by becoming a good steward through giving our GIG.

Gather:

Have you been a good role model to your members? How can you be a better role model to them?

Go Forth:

This week commit to be role-model to your members by posting in your social media your convictions or a picture of your latest family bonding or your latest service.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Focusing on the Lord

Goals:

- To learn how to have a single-mindedness for God.
- To commit to focus on the Lord in everything they do.

Grab:

Share about a moment in your life where you have lost your focus? How does it affected you?

Grace:

Read: 1 Corinthians 15: 8

There is a famous anecdote about a beleaguered army having to make a decision on whether to flee out to the sea in their boats or to stand and face the advancing enemy. The commander had their boats burned, thus eliminating the choice. This anecdote is the basis of one of the famous line we use in community that is “Burn your Boats”.

As MFC Youth household servants we should learn how to burn the boats that keeps us losing our focus in the Lord into the different things that the world is offering. To burn our boats means to have single-mindedness for God. We proved that God is our sole focus in life when we:

1. Seek to Grow in Christian Virtues

Growing in single-mindedness for God is connected with righteous living. Thus we need to acquired desirable Christian virtues (ex. Steadfastness, humility, obedience, courage, kindness) in order for us to be focus in God. Without personal virtues, we cannot be single-minded for God. There will always be some distractions that are too attractive.

2. Seek to Find Consolation Only from God

This is not only the proper attitude but a practical and realistic one. Everyone else can fail us, but God never will. In the midst of difficulty, especially from those closest to us, God is our consolation. It is only God who can truly comfort us.

3. Seek God's Will to be Done in your Life

We should not only be resigned to God's will, but actively and eagerly pray that His will come to pass in our life. But be careful. God delights in such prayers, and will grant them. So be ready to accept the will of the Lord in your life.

Gather:

What are the different things in your life right now that prevents you to focus on God?

Go Forth:

This week commit to spend more time with God through your prayer time or through adoring Him in the Blessed Sacrament.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Giving Encouragement

Goals:

- To learn how to give encouragement to your household.
- To commit to always give encouragement to your household.

Grab:

When was the last time you feel that you need encouragement?

Grace:

Read: 1 Thessalonians 5:11

Let us try to answer the following questions:

Are you able to get excited about the good things that happen to others? Are you able to tell them that you're glad? Can you enter into their joy? If you can, you are an encourager.

Are you living a committed Christian life? To what extent are you able to encourage others "to remain true to the Lord with all their hearts"? If you can, you are reflecting your own commitment to Christ. You are an encourager.

Are you able to accept other people for who they are? Do you see the best in people? Do you freely associate with people who are different from you? If you can, you are relatively free from prejudice and you are an encourager.

Literally the word "encourage" is a compound of two words: "en" meaning "to put in or into" and "courage" meaning strength and confidence. Thus as MFC Youth household servants we are to give confidence and strength to our members and we do this by:

- 1. Consistently Attending MFC Youth Activities** – our presence in our activities is a source of encouragement to all to continue to serve God through the community.
- 2. Turning to Scriptures** – Without the message of Scripture we would not have much with which to encourage one another. That is why make sure that you share inspired messages in your assemblies and hh meetings.
- 3. Praying for one another** – It is very encouraging to know that brothers and sisters are praying for you. In fact, that we are part of a worldwide network of prayer.
- 4. Saying a Positive and Encouraging Word to One Another** – we can truly encourage people when we say affirming words to them especially during times of problems and discouragement, but also on ordinary times.
- 5. Listen to one another** - People feel encouraged when they know that someone is listening to them.



Gather:

What prevents you from giving encouragement to people? How do you plan to improve on this?

Go Forth:

This week commit to do an act of encouragement to your household.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH

HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Giving Correction

Goals:

- To learn how to give correction to your household.
- To commit to always correct the household with love.

Grab:

When was the last time you were corrected? How does it feel?

Grace:

Read: Proverbs 12:1

The experience in most cultures is resistance of people to correction. This is because we are afraid to correct people. I think this is because we too have a negative experience of correction. Some of us experience being laughed at because of our mistakes (sometimes being embarrassed in front of other people). Some of us felt that when we were corrected we were evaluated of what we know and have achieved. Some have experience the pain of having their failures or shortcomings pointed out. However it is evident that correction is considered important in pastoral care. It ranks along with training in holiness. Thus as MFC Youth household servants we need to learn how to be able to lovingly correct the young people that God has entrusted to us in order for them to grow to be the man and woman that God wants them to be. We do this by:

- A. Look to our own behavior and attitudes** – We don't correct people without looking at ourselves first. We recognized that we correct not because we are perfect but because we love our brothers and sisters.
- B. Overcome fears about giving correction** – We are in a loving community! Our relationships are built with the strong sense of love for one another. Thus, we let go of our fears to correct our brothers and sisters and hold on to the deep of relationship that we have with them.
- C. Learn to handle anger** – There is no room for anger in a loving heart. Thus, as household servant we make sure that when we are correcting people it is not because we are mad at them rather we love them. We do not let our emotions get the best of us!
- D. Be willing to learn** – When we give correction make sure that you were able to get to the bottom of things before you start correcting your brothers and sisters. In the other hand, when we are being corrected have a posture of acceptance so that you may learn from the correction.
- E. Focus on the goals of pastoral care** – We give correction not to embarrassed people rather to show our love for them. We desire to encourage them to grow in holiness and that should be the only goal when we correct our brothers and sisters.

Gather:

What prevents you from giving correction to people? How do you plan to improve on this?

Go Forth:

This week commit to ask for a one to ones from your pastoral head and asked if they find something in them that needs to be corrected.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: The Power to Intercede

Goals:

- To learn how to give correction to your household.
- To commit to always correct your household with love.

Grab:

When was the last time you were corrected? How does it feel?

Grace:

Read: 1 Timothy 2:1-4

God always wants the best for us and He wants us to come to Him to ask for these things. But what gives more joy for God is when we asked for what is best for our brothers and sisters. This act is called "Intercession".

As MFC Youth household servants, it is our joy to intercede for our household. Thus, we strive to be an effective intercessor for them and we do this by:

1. Having a great love for the people you intercede for. Let us be ready to offer practical assistance to meet the needs for which you intercede.
2. Having a great faith in God that He could do things like what He did to Sarah, that he could part the waters of the Red Sea, that He can and will do the same things for us in whatever difficult situations we find ourselves in.
3. Striving to be holy. We know that we can only be effective intercessors if our relationship is right with God.
4. Looking for opportunities to intercede and use the power we have to intercede. Instead of complaining why not try to pray and intercede
5. Making a habit of regular intercession. We make intercession a regular part of your daily life and service.

Gather:

What are the things that you are praying to the Lord?

Go Forth:

This week commit to intercede for your brothers and sisters by praying for the things that they are asking for in the Lord that was shared in your discussion.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: The Power of Prayer

Goals:

- To learn the importance of prayer for a household servant.
- To commit to grow in one's prayer life.

Grab:

Who is the person that you love to talk to the most? What do you usually talk about?

Grace:

Read: 1 Thessalonians 5:16-18

Prayer is crucial to the life of a Christian, especially if you are serving as a household servant. This is because prayer is our direct communication link to God. When we pray we put ourselves into proper posture before God. That we need Him in our lives and apart from Him we are truly nothing. It keeps us trusting God for everything and makes us open to the way for the Holy Spirit to transform us to be more like Christ. What our posture should be when we pray:

1. Humility

Prayer is a humble response to God's invitation to be with Him and experience His great love for us. Thus, when we pray we need to surrender our lives to God's will. When we pray we do not insist on doing things our own way, but we recognize that God's way is perfect and that in everything He works for our good.

2. Honesty

When we pray we do not have to pretend before God. God knows all about us anyway. So when we pray we should just learn to share every part of our lives with Him. That includes our fears and failings, our moods and emotions, our thoughts and anxieties. When we are honest with God, He will work gently in our lives to mold us more and more into Jesus' likeness.

3. Forgiveness

We must first know God's forgiveness by confessing every known sin, repenting and asking for His cleansing. We must ask the Holy Spirit to search our hearts, and not allow the devil to rob us of God's peace. After confessing everything to God expect to receive His mercy and forgiveness.

4. Expectancy

When we ask for something in prayer, we should start looking for the answer and expect God to work. To help us pray with expectant faith, we need to know and claim the promises of God in the scriptures. Through these promises, we know the will of God and that He is faithful.

5. Persistency

We can become careless and lazy in our prayer. Due to the many things that we do we can sometimes neglect it altogether. We may give lip service when we pray by mouthing off a few familiar phrases, but our heart and mind may wander in many directions. Though God may answer even our casual prayers, normally He waits until our whole being is concentrated on Him.



Gather:

What prevents you from fully spending time with the Lord in prayer? How do you plan to improve on this?

Go Forth:

This week commit to focus to pray during your prayer time.



MISSIONARY FAMILIES OF CHRIST – YOUTH

HH SERVANTS' JUMPSTART MANUAL

Title: Faith the Moves Mountains

Goals:

- To learn the importance of having faith in God.
- To commit to always lived by our faith.

Grab:

Share about an experience where you have felt God's faithfulness?

Grace:

Read: Matthew 21:21

We are to be men and women of faith. In the bible there are two meanings of faith, the first one, is to believe in the existence of God. The other is to trust that God is true in His dealings with mankind. I believe that all of us here believe that God is real but what is sometimes difficult for us to believe is that God will forever be true to us. However, when you read the bible you will see that in the salvation history, God is faithful to His people in words and action. This is proven definitely when He sends Jesus Christ to die for our sins. Since God has proven to be faithful we need to resolve to be faithful to Him as well. We can show our faithfulness to Him by:

1. Trusting in God

All of us have given up something, some of us a great deal, to serve the Lord and to be here right now. What guarantee do we have that it will all be worth it? What do we have to say to counter the arguments of friends and family who so reasonably show us the seeming foolishness of our direction in life? We have no guarantee but the faithfulness of God.

2. Believing in God's work in MFC Youth

In and through MFC Youth we are attempting to make all youth to know Christ. We are striving to do something significant for the cause of Christ. What guarantee do we have that MFC Youth will survive another 10 years; that this ark we are building is going to be of any use; that this is a worthy work to engage in at the expense of family, of career, of personal preferences? We have no guarantee but the faithfulness of God.

3. Growing in Faith

Let us not look at our lives with human eyes or allow events to distract or discourage us. Let us be like Abraham with the knife at Isaac's throat, like Noah building his ark, like Mary abandoning all her cares to God. Let us fully trust that He who began a good work in us will indeed bring it to completion on the day of Christ Jesus (Philippians 1:6).



Gather:

What prevents you believing that God is faithful to you? How do you plan to improve on this?

Go Forth:

This week commit to grow in faith by asking God in prayer the grace to increase your faith, to live your life based on the truth of God's faithfulness and to always act in faith.